

Cardiovascular risk and contraceptives

1. Cardiovascular risk factors that will affect contraceptive use

- a. Risk of forming clots in veins
- b. Pre-diabetes
- c. Have diabetes with complications
- d. Have high blood pressure
- e. Have had a blood clot or blockage in the heart
- f. Have problems with heart valves
- g. Smoking and more than 35 years
- h. Have had a stroke

2. How different contraceptives work

How the different type of contraceptives work

A. Natural contraceptive Methods

- A woman has to observe and notice the different phases of her menstrual cycle and the changes in her body at each phase
- She should be able to know the days when the ovary is likely to release an egg (ovulation)
- She should avoid sex during the period when the ovary is likely to release an egg
- Natural family planning methods include;
 - Calendar method
 - Standard day method (cycle beads)
 - Billing's method
 - Lactation amenorrhea method

B. Barrier contraceptive Methods

- These methods either do not allow the semen to enter the vagina or the neck of the womb (cervix)
- The most common barrier method is the male and female condom
- Other types of barrier methods are diaphragm, spermicide, sponging tablet

C. Hormonal contraceptive Methods

Hormonal contraceptives methods contain hormones that work in three ways;

1. Prevent ovulation that is makes the ovaries not to release eggs
2. Prevents the womb from accepting the egg
3. Prevents sperm from reaching the egg to fertilize the it

Hormonal family planning methods include;

- Oral pills
- Injectable

- Implants
- Intra-uterine systems (LNG-IUS)

3. What contraceptives affect cardiovascular risk factors?

1. Natural contraceptive methods, barrier methods and non-hormonal intra-uterine contraceptive devices/systems do not increase cardiovascular risk factors. But natural methods do not work very well if it is not used exactly as recommended. Some apps support the use of natural contraceptive methods
2. There are heart health concerns associated with hormonal contraceptives

4. How do hormonal contraceptives affect cardiovascular risk factors

1. LNG- INTRA UTERINE SYSTEM

- Can be used by women living with cardiovascular risk factors. Failure rate is very low. Last up to 5 years.
- Less than 1 out of 100 women using this method will get pregnant

2. IMPLANTS

- Can be used by women living with the conditions above besides stroke. Cannot be continued in a woman with a history of stroke. Has low failure rate. Last up to 3- 5 years.

3. DMPA (DEPO-PROVERA)

- Cannot be used by women with a history of stroke, uncontrolled hypertension or diabetes with organ damage.
- It is a short acting but effective method.
- It requires injections taken every three months

4. PROGESTERON ONLY PILLS

- It is a short acting but effective method that requires taking pills every day.
- Can be used by women living with a cardiovascular risk factor besides stroke.
- Cannot be continued in a woman with a history of stroke. Short acting and effective

5. COMBINED HORMONAL CONTRACEPTIVES

- They contain both progesterone and estrogens. Examples are combined oral pills, combined hormonal injections like Noristerat, combined hormonal patches and other systems that use combined hormonal contraceptives
- Cannot be used by women living with any of the cardiovascular risk factors listed below
 - Risk of forming clots in veins
 - Pre-diabetes
 - Have diabetes with complications
 - Have high blood pressure
 - Have had a blood clot or blockage in the heart
 - Have problems with heart valves
 - Smoking and more than 35 years
 - Have had a stroke

